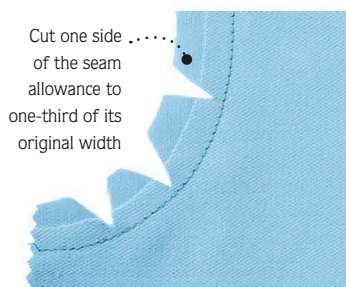
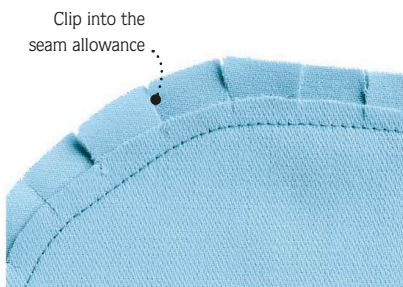


## REDUCING SEAM BULK

Sometimes you may need to reduce the bulk in curved seams to help your patchwork lie flat. This is usually used on 3-dimensional objects.



**Reducing bulk on an inner curve** Layer the seam by cutting along one side of the seam allowance to reduce it to one-third of its original width. Then cut out V notches to reduce the bulk. Do not cut through the stitching.

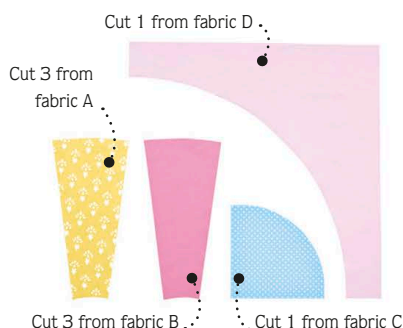


**Reducing bulk on an outer curve** Layer the seam and clip through the seam allowances to reduce bulk.

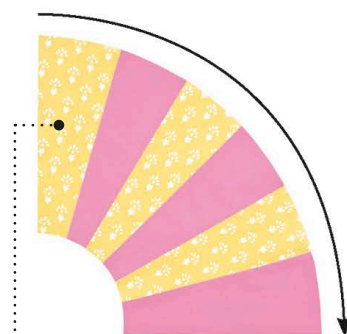
## FANS



**1** Transfer the outlines to card or template plastic and cut out the shapes. Make two sets of templates – set 1 for the cutting lines, and set 2 with the seam allowances trimmed off the curved edges for the stitching line.



**2** For a six-blade fan, cut three blades each from fabrics A and B. Cut a small corner piece from fabric C and a background from fabric D.

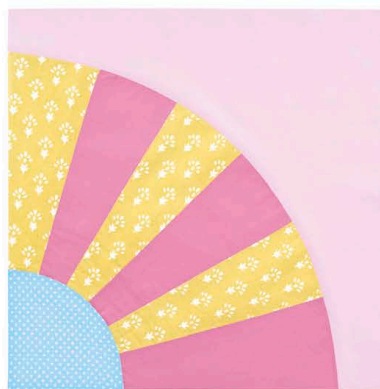


**3** Join the fan blade pieces, alternating the colours and taking a 6mm ( $\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam allowance. Press the blades in the same direction.



**4** Mark the seam allowances on the top and bottom edges of the fan unit.

**5** Mark the seam allowance on the small corner piece and pin it to the lower edge of the fan unit. Join them as in Steps 5 and 6 of Drunkard's path (see pp.86–87). Press towards the fan.



**6** Mark the seam allowance on the background piece and pin the background piece to the upper edge of the fan unit. Join them as before. Press towards the background.